

What is the general way in which DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams are constructed?

As discussed earlier, various types of diagrams and visual models are increasingly being used at multiple levels within government.

People often 'just draw' ad hoc models and diagrams to make a point by presenting information visually. They draw such models in any way that they think will help busy decision-makers understand what a proposed strategy, policy or initiative will do and the outcomes it is attempting to influence. In addition to ad hoc diagrams, people involved in planning are also increasingly drawing specific types of models that go by different names such as: intervention logics, theories of change, program theories, program logics, results chains, results roadmaps, outcomes models and strategy diagrams.

The DoView standardized interactive drill-down strategy/outcomes diagrams used in DoView Planning are a particular type of visual strategy model. Their layout is illustrated in the tool on the next page. They are drawn according to a formal set of DoView Drawing Rules to ensure that they are fit-for-purpose for all stages of the government planning, action and reporting process. These standardized DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams set out all of the higher-level outcomes for an initiative or policy, and all of the lower-level steps it is believed need to occur to achieve them in a 'This-Then' box format.

One way of thinking about these diagrams is to imagine them rather like a visual diagram of a road trip as is illustrated in this tool - the DoView Strategy/Outcomes Diagram Shown as a Roadtrip Example (B3). It shows a 'Route 66 DoView Strategy/Outcomes Diagram'. Route 66 is a classic United States' roadtrip. This tool provides a very simple example of the concept of a DoView strategy diagram used throughout this toolkit. Note that in practice, real world DoViews usually contain a number of drill-down levels below the top level.

DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams can be drawn from bottom-to-top or from left-to-right. The left-to-right approach has advantages for readers whose language is read from left-to-right. In such cases, a reader's eye is naturally drawn across the diagram from initial steps on the left to the outcomes that are located on the right-hand side.